

Citizenship

Plutarch
Current Events
American Gov./ Economics
Community Read Alouds
Ethics





About the Course

This course includes the following topic(s): Plutarch: Grades 6-8, American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8, Ethics: Part 2, Current Events: Grades 5-8, Community Read Alouds: Grades 1-12

About Plutarch: Grades 6-8

Plutarch's Lives is a collection of biographies written 2,000 years ago, which has influenced prominent thinkers from Montaigne to Bacon to Shakespeare. Plutarch's stories are often difficult to read (and are therefore often dropped by teachers), but their value to help students evaluate the characteristics that define a good citizen cannot be overstated. The lesson plans will contain additional support to what is already included in the Anne White guides.

About Current Events: Grades 5-8

Students are exposed to current events by reading from a variety of sources and having age-appropriate conversations with teachers. Topics such as scientific discoveries, the arts, and human interest stories are generally suitable.

About American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8

Students spend a term learning the structure of our local and state governments, then turn to key primary source documents related to our government before ending the year with an introduction to economics, focusing on the history of money, the banking system, and personal finance.

About Community Read Alouds: Grades 1-12

This is meant to be a read-aloud for all ages to enjoy together in the afternoon at least 1 time a week. We encourage you to choose a book that is specific to your region. However, we will offer some suggestions in the Grades 1-3 Literature lessons and Grades 4+ Citizenship lessons. The suggested book titles will be available June 1st in the lesson plans.

About Ethics: Part 2

Students will explore characteristics shared by all Image-Bearers and learn how to guard against good servants becoming bad masters by continuing Charlotte Mason's text written directly to students.



Placement & Combining Tips

Plutarch: Grades 6-8

Students in 5th grade or new to Plutarch may want to take the Beginner's Track, which covers the life of Publicola over two terms. It is advisable to have students read Beesly's Stories From the History of Rome and complete one year of Shakespeare before beginning Plutarch.

American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8

If a student hasn't studied the Constitution, consider having them take the 7th-grade government course first.

Ethics: Part 2

Ourselves by Charlotte Mason is scheduled over five years. In a multi-age context, students can jump into the book wherever the class is reading. Otherwise, students should begin the book in Part 1.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
6-8+	Plutarch: Grades 6-8 1 time/week 30 min	Historical Atlas of the World 6th Ed. The Plutarch Project Volume Three (Revised)
5-8	Current Events: Grades 5-8 1+ time/week 15 min	
8	American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 1 time/week 30 min	Dollars and Sense: A Kid's Guide to Using - Not Losing - Money Reading PDF
1-12	Community Read Alouds: Grades 1-12 1+ time/week 20 min+	
8+	Ethics: Part 2 1 time/week 25 min	Ourselves: Book 1

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)				
Ethics: Part 2 Community Read Alouds: Grades 1-12		American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 Current Events: Grades 5-8		Plutarch: Grades 6-8



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)

☐ Make sure your student sets up a Citizenship Notebook. They will need a 3-ring binder, lined notebook paper, and 5 Tabbed Dividers. You can read more about how to set one up and suggestions for various sections in the document in Quick Links.

☐ As desired, plan for a read aloud time. Suggestions are provided in the Community Read Aloud Quick Link, but local favorites are highly recommended whenever possible.

☐ Make a Calendar of Events for Current Events lessons by drawing a calendar grid in a notebook (or print a blank calendar from the internet).

Plutarch: Grades 6-8

☐ Watch the video in Quick Links about teaching Plutarch.

American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8

☐ Save or print the Reading PDF. (See Quick Links)



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)

Plutarch: Grades 6-8



Historical Atlas of the World 6th Ed.



The Plutarch Project Volume Three (Revised)

American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8



Dollars and Sense: A Kid's Guide to Using - Not Losing - Money



Reading PDF

Ethics: Part 2



Ourselves: Book 1



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)

- ∞ [Extra Helpings](#)
- ∞ [Community Read Alouds](#)
- ∞ [Setting Up a Citizenship Notebook](#)

Plutarch: Grades 6-8

- ∞ [Video: How to Teach Plutarch \(see Citizenship: Section 7\)](#)

Current Events: Grades 5-8

- ∞ [The Pour Over | Subscribe](#)
- ∞ [The World and Everything In It](#)
- ∞ [World Watch \(Paid Subscription Required\)](#)
- ∞ [The Sift](#)
- ∞ [BBC](#)
- ∞ [Teaching Kids News \(CA\)](#)
- ∞ [1Jour1Actu \(in French\)](#)

American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8

- ∞ [Grade 8 Reading PDF: State & Local Gov](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)

How To Teach



Prepare

Plutarch: Teachers will find it helpful to preread the entire Life first, and then preread the day's passage before each lesson. Mark any passages that should be omitted due to content. (In Anne White's Plutarch Project books, the recommended source for this course, objectionable content has already been omitted.)

Current Events: Preview the news source for suitability.

Most other citizenship topics don't require additional prep.



Recap

Connect back to the previous lesson. (Optional for Current Events).



Introduce

For news sources, show students how to scan the headlines to get an overview first and then choose a story to read.

For Plutarch or other books: Use a picture, a map, or an engaging question to prepare students to receive the story as relevant. You may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding. It is not necessary to cover all unfamiliar words.



Read

Read the selection assigned or the news story chosen. For rich, dense, or more challenging books such as *Ourselves* and *Plutarch*, it is a good idea to read them aloud. Have students keep an eye out for things to add to their Citizenship Notebook, *Book of Centuries*, and/or *Commonplace* book.



Narrate

Have the students narrate orally or in writing.



Discuss

Give students an opportunity to share their thoughts on the story and any connections made. For current events, look up where events occurred on a map and ask questions to help students discern the quality of the piece. (e.g., Are there sources cited? Is there an obvious bias? If so, what do other authors have to say on this subject? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?) Consider reading an alternative perspective.



Citizenship Notebook

Have students record important ideas in their Citizenship Notebooks.

Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1 25m Ethics: Part 2 - Lesson 1

Materials: Ourselves: Book 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.VIII p.73-75 "The Desire of Society" - "get at it."

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Choose a habit you would like to cultivate and tell a little about why. Draw a chart for keeping up with your new habit and check in daily.

• COMPOSITION - Journal

Tell of a time when your desire for society was met. How did that experience impact/affect you?

WEEK 1 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 1

Introduction to State & Local Government

Materials: Reading PDF

→ INTRO

This term, we will learn about state and local governments. While we will focus on state and local government, we will sometimes reference the federal government to compare and contrast the state and local powers with federal powers.

→ READ

∞ Link: Reading PDF
p.2-4

→ REFLECT

Narrate. Write a summary statement or draw a diagram describing the main ideas from this week's reading.

WEEK 1 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 1

Julius Caesar

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: We highly recommend reading a retelling so you can be familiar with the story. This is for your understanding and should not be read to the students.

∞ Link: Retelling of Caesar (from Our Young Folks' Plutarch)

- Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ INTRO

Have you ever heard of Julius Caesar? If so, what do you know about him?

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Julius Caesar Image
∞ Video Link: Julius Caesar Video

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

1. Take 1-2 minutes to look over the map of the Roman Republic and the surrounding "world" in Caesar's time.
2. Find Rome in Italy.
3. Find the Aegean Sea between the province of Asia and Achaea. This is the coastline where the pirates operated.
4. Find Bithynia on the southern shore of the Black Sea, where Caesar went after his release.
5. These are the places where a teenager on the wrong side of Roman politics spent his first years away from home.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

★ TEACHER TIP

To keep track of all of the characters in the story, it may be helpful for your student to keep a list or chart of some kind in their citizenship notebook. They could also sketch the characters and include facts about them. Or, you could use the linked character cards.

∞ Link: Character Cards

★ TEACHER NOTE

Watch this overview video to help with the Character Simulator

∞ Video Link: Character Simulator

• CHARACTERS

-**Julius Caesar (JOOL-yus, SEE-zar):** Roman statesman and general, held many high civic, military, and religious positions, and was a noted orator and writer.

-**Sulla (SUH-luh):** was made the Perpetual Dictator, but resigned after one year and was elected as a consul instead.

Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson One: Parts One - Three p.9-12

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

In the introduction of Lesson One, we learn that "young Julius Caesar was on the wrong side. Most people in that position would have stayed hidden or at least tried to live quietly" (p.7). In a situation where staying silent means comfort and safety, what factors or beliefs might make a person decide that standing up is worth the risk?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

If you found yourself on the "wrong side" of a big decision at school or with your friends, and staying quiet was the only way to stay safe and comfortable, how would you decide which ideas are worth being "exiled" for and which ones are just you being stubborn?

-Cinna (SIN-uh): There are several Cinna in the story. This Cinna, Lucius Cornelius Cinna the Elder, is Caesar's first father-in-law and ally of Marius, Caesar's uncle.

-Marius (MARR-ee-us): involved in a Civil War against Sulla and was an ally of Cinna, the father-in-law of Caesar

-King Nicomedes (nih-kuh-MEE-deez): King of Bithynia 94-74 BC

-Marcus Juncus (MAHR-kuss, JUNG-kuss): governor of Asia in 75 BC

WEEK 1 ☐ 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice
PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 2 ☐ 25m Ethics: Part 2 - Lesson 2

☐ Materials: Ourselves: Book 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.VIII p.75-77 "Dangers attending" - "the great world."

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Update habits log. Start a chart where you can list desirable human character traits on one side and their daemons on the other.

• COMPOSITION

Tell of a time when you took a "share in the interests of the great world" by listening with all your heart to someone who shared about a profession, skill, subject, or experience with which you were unfamiliar.

Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 2 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 2

Origins of Authority: Constitutions & Police Powers

Materials: Reading PDF

→ INTRO

States have two sources of authority that allow them to create and enforce laws: 1) constitutional powers and 2) police powers. These sources of authority are the basis for the laws and regulations that states pass, as well as the authority that states grant to smaller local governments, like cities and towns.

→ READ

∞ Link: Reading PDF
p.5-8

→ REFLECT

Narrate. Write a summary statement or draw a diagram describing the main ideas from this week's reading.

WEEK 2 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 2

Julius Caesar

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What did we learn so far about Caesar from the first reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

1. Find Hither Spain and Farther Spain on the western edge of the map. Both are already "Roman Pink."
2. Find the Alps. This is the route Caesar traveled when he passed through a tiny village and said, "For my part, I had rather be the chiefest man here, than the second person in Rome" (p.15, The Plutarch Project).

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful to write definitions into the text, so you do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Two: Parts One - Three p.14-17

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" and "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are a young officer who rode with Caesar when he passed through a tiny village in the Alps and said he would rather be the first man there than the second in Rome. What do you think about that comment?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

Explain how you might distinguish between a person who wants to do great things and a person who simply wants to be the greatest.

★ TEACHER NOTE

The map shows the world in 31 BC, shortly after Caesar's time. You will notice Italy is shaded pink; while it was the Roman Homeland and not a province, it is colored here to show it was under central Roman control.

While all of Gaul is pink on this map, remember that when Caesar began his command, only the southern tip belonged to Rome. His campaigns were what eventually brought the rest of that territory into the Empire.

• DEFINITIONS

Pontifex Maximus: There were numerous levels and types of priesthood in Rome and throughout the rest of Italy, and these positions carried political as well as spiritual authority.

• CHARACTERS

-Catulus (kuh-TUL-uhs): an avowed enemy to the Marian (Marius's) party

-Isauricus (eye-SAW-rih-kus): a consul and general who fought against the Cilician pirates

-Crassus (KRAS-us): Roman senator and a conspirator against Caesar

-Cato (KAY-toe): statesman who had many conflicts of opinion against Caesar

Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

-Alexander (al-ig-ZAN-der):
Alexander the Great

-Calpurnius Bibulus (kal-PUR-nee-us, BIB-yoo-lus): consul alongside Caesar

WEEK 2 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice
PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 3 25m Ethics: Part 2 - Lesson 3

☐ Materials: Ourselves: Book 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.VIII p.77-78 "The Desire of Knowledge" - "ourselves!"

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Update habits log and character traits chart.

- **COMPOSITION - Compare/Contrast**
Compare and contrast the desire for knowledge and curiosity.

WEEK 3 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 3

State Constitutions

☐ Materials: Reading PDF

→ INTRO

Last week, we explored sources of power for states. One of these sources is the state constitution. This week, you will familiarize yourself with your state's constitution.

→ READ

∞ Link: Reading PDF
p.9

→ REFLECT

Narrate. Write a summary statement or draw a diagram describing the main ideas from this week's reading.

Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 3 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 3

Julius Caesar

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

1. Find Transalpine Gaul and the Rhine River marking the boundary between Gaul and Germania.
2. Notice that Germania is entirely outside the Roman pink. This is the boundary Caesar was about to push.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Three: Parts One - Three p.19-23

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" and "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are one of Caesar's soldiers who has watched him for days while he was ill and exhausted. Tonight he is sick again. What do you think about his choices while chronically ill (p.22)?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

Describe the different ways Caesar and his companions responded to the dish served by their host in Milan (p.23).

★ TEACHER NOTE

Germania was entirely outside Roman control.

- The Rhine was the line Caesar pushed against, even crossing it twice (in 55 BC and 53 BC) to build famous bridges and conduct show of force expeditions.
- Despite these incursions, Rome never successfully turned the main body of Germania into a permanent province, even in the centuries following Caesar.

• CULTURAL CONNECTION

Sweet Ointment: also translated "oil of perfume" or "myrrh." It appears that Valerius Leo hadn't just pulled out the wrong bottle of salad dressing, but rather that he was trying to show off his wealth. The reference to the host's want of breeding seems to confirm that.

• CHARACTERS

-**Servilius Caepio (ser-VIL-ee-us, SEE-pee-oh):** engaged to Caesar's daughter, Julia

-**Piso (PEE-so):** consul in 58 BC

-**Clodius (KLOH-dee-us):** interrupted a women's religious ritual and was the cause of Caesar's divorce from Pompeia

WEEK 3 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 4 25m Ethics: Part 2 - Lesson 4

Materials: Ourselves: Book 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.VIII p.78-79 "Emulation and the Love" - "or in life."

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Update habits log and character traits chart.

• COMPOSITION - Cause & Effect

How is the love of knowledge smothered by emulation? Include "marks" and "places" in your examples.

WEEK 4 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 4

State Constitutions: The Preamble

Materials: Reading PDF

→ INTRO

Although they do not have "legal effect," the preamble to a constitution is an important statement. This week, you will examine your state constitution's preamble and consider its importance.

→ READ

∞ Link: Reading PDF
p.10-13

→ REFLECT

Narrate. For your summary statement this week, analyze your state constitution's preamble as described in the Reading PDF on page 13.

WEEK 4 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 4

Julius Caesar

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

1. Find the Rhine separating Gaul from Germania.
2. Find Cisalpine Gaul south of the Alps.
3. Trace north from Cisalpine Gaul all the way to the Rhine. This is the distance those men were willing to march.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Four: Parts One - Four p.26-30

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" and "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

Caesar "never failed to dismiss all with present pledges of his kindness in hand, and further hopes for the future" (p.29). As one of his soldiers, you've just watched him march over a bridge of fallen soldiers. Now, he stands before you, gives you gold, and speaks of the future with hope. How do you make sense of the leader you saw at the river and the

• CHARACTERS

-**Labienus** (lay-bee-EE-nuhs):
tribune, one of Caesar's lieutenants, but a supporter of Pompey

-**Ariovistus** (ar-ee-oh-VIS-təs):
leader of the Suebi people, one of a group of Germanic tribes

Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

generous, hopeful man standing in front of you now?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

Caesar "commanded them that were afraid, that they should depart home, and not put themselves in danger against their wills" (p.27-28). How would you respond if you were one of the "young gentlemen of noble houses of Rome, who thought to have gone to the wars with him as only for their pleasure and gain" and Caesar was sending you home (p.27)?

WEEK 4 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 5 25m Ethics: Part 2 - Lesson 5

☐ Materials: Ourselves: Book 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.VIII p.79-80 "All Persons have Powers" - "the battle."

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Update habits log and character traits chart.

• COMPOSITION

Tell of a time when you have thrown yourself into your work and it was a delight to you. OR Tell of a character in a book who has done so and the result was joy.

WEEK 5 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 5

State Government

☐ Materials: Reading PDF

→ INTRO

Today, you will learn about your state government.

→ READ

∞ Link: Reading PDF
p.14

→ NOTEBOOK

Answer the questions about your state in your Citizenship Notebook.

Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 5 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 5

Julius Caesar

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

1. Find Arverni, where Vercingetorix and the Arverni lived.
2. Find Alesia. Notice the rivers and terrain, and consider why Caesar chose to build where he did.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Five: Parts One - Two p.32-36

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" and "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are Vercingetorix, riding out of the gates of Alesia in full armor to give yourself up. What do you think about the choice you are making?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

Look closely at the rivers surrounding Alesia. How might these help a general trying to keep an army from escaping?

• CHARACTERS

-Ambiorix (am-bee-OR-iks):
leader of the Eburones from Gaul

-Quintus Tullius Cicero (KWIN-tuss, TUL-lee-uss, SIS-er-oh):
military leader during Caesar's Gallic Wars

-Vercingetorix (VUR-sin-JET-uh-riks): king of the captured Arverni tribe

WEEK 5 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 6 25m Ethics: Part 2 - Lesson 6

Materials: Ourselves: Book 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.I p.81-83 "The Lords of the House" - "feel it."

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Update character traits chart. Think of a new habit you would like to cultivate and create a tracking chart.

• COMPOSITION - Poetry

Write a poem about selfless love using your own examples patterned after soldiers, mothers, nurses, missionaries, etc.

WEEK 6 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 6

State Legislative Branch

Materials: Reading PDF

→ INTRO

This week, you will review the sections of your state constitution that address the legislative branch, and look up your state government representatives.

→ READ

∞ Link: Reading PDF
p.15-18

→ REFLECT

Write a summary statement or draw a diagram describing the main ideas from this week's reading.

WEEK 6 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 6

Julius Caesar

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

1. Find the Rubicon.
2. Locate Brundisium on the Adriatic coast.
3. Find Dyrrhachium across the Ionian Sea and notice the distance Caesar was asking his army to cross.
4. Consider the risk of moving a massive force across that stretch of the Ionian Sea while being hunted by an enemy fleet.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Six: Parts One - Two p.38-42

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" and "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are Asinius Pollio, standing beside Caesar at the Rubicon while he talks through what crossing will mean. What do you think as you listen to

• CHARACTERS

-Antony (AN-tuh-nee): Mark Antony

-Scipio (SIH-pih-oh): senator, consul, and military commander

-Lentulus (LEN-tyoo-lus): consul

-Asinius Pollio (uh-SIN-ee-us, POL-ee-oh): Roman orator and historian



Term 1

him (p.41-42)? → WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE) On the banks of the Rubicon, Caesar's abstract plan shifts to the reality of the action. Describe what he sees and feels in that moment of doubt as he considers the "desperateness of his attempt" (p.41).	
WEEK 6 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker <i>Tracker:</i> News source of your choice PREP: Preview news source → INTRO Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news). → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS News story • What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible? → LOCATE Look at a map and find where the events occurred → NOTEBOOK Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.	
WEEK 7 25m Ethics: Part 2 - Lesson 7 Materials: Ourselves: Book 1 → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.I p.83-86 "Love delights in the Goodness" - "Waiting." → CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK Update habits log and character traits chart.	• COMPOSITION - Expository Explain the four ways in which a person is able to recognize authentic love.
WEEK 7 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 7 <i>State Executive Branch</i> Materials: Reading PDF → INTRO This week, you will review the sections of your state constitution that address the executive branch and read about your state's governor. → READ ∞ Link: Reading PDF p.19 → REFLECT Write a summary statement or draw a diagram describing the main ideas from this week's reading.	

Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 7 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 7

Julius Caesar p.42-50

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

1. Trace the route Caesar used to move through Italy in sixty days without a major battle.
2. Find Corfinium, where Domitius surrendered.
3. Locate Brundisium, where Pompey escaped by sea.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Seven: Parts One - Four p.45-49

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" and "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are Labienus, Caesar's most trusted general for ten years, the night you walked out of his camp for the last time. What do you think about the man you are leaving (p.46)?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

Caesar said, "Time of war and law are two things" (p.47). What does he mean?

• CHARACTERS

-Domitius (duh-MISH-ee-uhs): enemy of Caesar and Cato's brother-in-law

-Publius Servilius Isauricus (PUB-lee-uhs, ser-VIL-ee-uhs, eye-SAWR-ih-kuhs): co-consul and friend of Caesar

WEEK 7 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 8 25m Ethics: Part 2 - Lesson 8

Materials: Ourselves: Book 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.II p.87-89 "Knights and Ladies of Pity" - "idle pity."

- How could you show that all people possess and express pity?

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Update habits log and character traits chart.

WEEK 8 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 8

State Judicial Branch

Materials: Reading PDF

→ INTRO

This week, you will review the sections of your state constitution that address the judicial branch and read about your state's highest court.

→ READ

∞ Link: Reading PDF
p.20

→ REFLECT

Write a summary statement or draw a diagram describing the main ideas from this week's reading.

WEEK 8 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 8

Julius Caesar

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

1. Find the city of Rome in Italy and cross the Adriatic Sea to the province of Macedonia, the rugged region where the Battle of Pharsalus was fought.
2. Find Pharsalus.
3. Trace the coastline south to Alexandria and the Kingdom of the Ptolemies, where the defeated Pompey eventually fled for refuge.
4. These are the locations where the future of the Roman world was decided as Caesar pursued his rival across the Mediterranean.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Eight, Parts One - Three p.51-56

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" and "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

★ TEACHER NOTE

The writing prompt is slightly uncomfortable by design, because understanding someone's fears in order to respond more effectively sits right on the edge between wisdom and manipulation.

• CHARACTERS

-**Spinther (SPIN-ther)**: nickname for Publius Cornelius Lentulus

-Gnaeus Domitius Calvinus (NEE-us, doh-MISH-ee-us, cal-VYE-nus): general and consul and loyal to Caesar

-**Quintus Cornificus (KWIN-tus, cor-NIF-ih-kus)**: quaestor for Illyricum

-**Calenus (kuh-LEE-nuhs)**: Roman general and consul

Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

You are one of Caesar's soldiers who ran to meet him when he returned to shore, and you are angry. Your general just risked his life sneaking across a war zone in a twelve-oar boat dressed as a slave, without telling anyone. What specifically bothers you about what he did, and what does your reaction say about what you believe a leader owes the people who follow him?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

Caesar's plan to aim at the faces of the young cavalymen worked because he thought carefully about who they actually were, not just what they were doing on the battlefield. Describe a conflict or disagreement you have had where understanding the other person's specific fears or weaknesses would have changed how you approached the situation.

WEEK 8 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker

Tracker:

News source of your choice
PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 9 25m Ethics: Part 2 - Lesson 9

Materials: Ourselves: Book 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.II p.89-90 "Self-Pity." - "sorry for ourselves."

• CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Update habits log and character traits chart this week.

• COMPOSITION - Story

Write a fable-type short story in which a character's self-pity is exposed and he overcomes it.

WEEK 9 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 9

Local Governments

Materials: Reading PDF

→ INTRO

You have read about the federal government and the state government. Today, you will look at local government. Local governments are a paradox because we most often forget that they exist, while they often have the most direct impact on our daily lives. This week, we will look at what they are and where local governments derive their authority (hint: it's not the Constitution).

→ READ

∞ Link: Reading PDF
p.21-24

Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

→ REFLECT

Narrate. Write a summary statement or short narration describing the main ideas from this week's reading.

WEEK 9 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 9

Julius Caesar

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

1. Find Alexandria on its Mediterranean coast. This is where Caesar spent months managing a dangerous court, a burning library, a treacherous eunuch, and a queen smuggled in through a castle gate in a bundle. He nearly drowned here.
2. Move northeast into Syria, which Caesar passed through on his way to deal with the next problem before the Egyptian one was fully settled.
3. Find Pontus on the southern shore of the Black Sea. This is where Pharnaces had overrun Roman territory while Caesar was occupied in Alexandria. Caesar arrived, fought, and sent a three-word letter back to Rome. The whole thing was over before the letter arrived.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Nine: Parts One - Three p.58-61

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" and "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are one of Pompey's soldiers who has just been taken prisoner and is now being folded into Caesar's legions. Yesterday, you were fighting against this man. Today, he is your general. What do you do with that, and what would you need to see from him before you trusted him (p.58-59)?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE): PICK 1

Caesar "daily saved the lives of some of his countrymen that bore arms against him" and considered this the greatest pleasure of his victory. Think of a conflict, whether between people, groups, or ideas, where the most meaningful thing a winner could do afterward was show restraint or generosity. What makes that kind of choice hard, and what makes it worth it (p.59)?

"Veni, Vidi, Vici" worked because it was short, precise, and matched the reality of what had actually happened. Think of a time when you had to report something, explain yourself, or sum up a complicated situation for someone else. What is lost when we say too much, and what is lost when we say too little (p.61)?

• CHARACTERS

-**Cleopatra (KLEE-oh-PA-truh):** co-ruler of Egypt with her brother, Ptolemy XIV

-**Pothinus the Eunuch (PAH-thin-uhs):** high-ranking servant of King Ptolemy XIII and regent of Ptolemy XIV

-**Achillas (uh-KILL-uhss):** guardian of King Ptolemy and one of the murderers of Pompey

-**Caesarion (see-ZAR-ee-on):** Caesar's son and last pharaoh of Egypt

-**Pharnaces (FAR-nuh-seez):** his father conquered many territories, including Bithynia and Cappadocia

Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 9 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 10 25m Ethics: Part 2 - Lesson 10

Materials: Ourselves: Book 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.III p.91-92 "Reform the World" - "better work."

- Why are faults not the whole of a person? Have you ever felt like all you could see was a person's faults? What did you do?

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Update habits log and character traits chart.

WEEK 10 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 10

Local Governments in Action

Materials: Reading PDF

→ INTRO

This week, you'll focus on how local governments impact our daily lives by reading some current events. Your Reading PDF includes several suggested articles, as well as tips for finding a good article about your local government.

→ READ

∞ Link: Reading PDF
p.25

→ REFLECT

Write a summary statement or draw a diagram describing the main ideas from the article you read.

Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 10 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 10

Julius Caesar

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

1. Find Sicily, where Caesar camped on the seashore in winter to cut off any thought of delay.
2. Then trace his crossing south to the African coast and the battle at Thapsus, where three camps fell in a single day.
3. Follow him back to Rome for the triumphs and the honors, then west to Spain and the battle at Munda, where Pompey's sons nearly killed him, and back to Rome again. He covered all of this inside two years.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Ten: Parts One - Three p.64-68

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" and "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are one of Caesar's friends who has just urged him to accept a personal bodyguard, and he has refused, saying it is "better to die once than always to be afraid of death." You believe there are real plots against him. How would you respond to his answer (p.68)?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

Caesar put a man of the right family name at the head of his troops specifically to counter an oracle his enemies believed in. He may have been mocking it, or he may have been sincere; Plutarch says it is hard to tell. Think about a time when you did something that could have been interpreted two very different ways depending on who was watching. Do your intentions fully determine the meaning of an action, or does it matter how others read it (p.65)?

• CHARACTERS

-**Scipio (SIH-pih-oh):** senator, consul, and military commander

-**King Juba I (JOO-buh):** King of Numidia

-**Gaius Asinius Pollio (GAY-us, uh-SIN-ee-us, PAHL-ee-oh):** soldier, politician, historian, and writer

-**Afranius (uh-FRAY-nee-us):** former consul and Pompey's lieutenant in Spain

-**Juba II (JOO-buh):** King of Numidia and Mauretania, scholar and author, raised in Rome by Caesar and his nephew

WEEK 10 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 11 25m Ethics: Part 2 - Lesson 11

Materials: Ourselves: Book 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.III p.92-94 "The Affairs of Goodwill." - "meaning for us."

- Can you give an example for each of the three enemies of Goodwill?

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Write a brief reflection on how you did with habit cultivation this term.

WEEK 11 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 11

Catch Up and Exploring Local Government Resources

Materials: Reading PDF

→ INTRO

This week, you will learn more about your local government.

→ NOTEBOOK

∞ Link: Reading PDF
p.26-27

Answer the questions about your town/county in your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 11 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 11

Julius Caesar

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

1. Find Rome. Now stay there, because that is where the entire lesson takes place. After a life of crossing seas and marching through impassable terrain, the whole lesson fits inside a single city.
2. Find Philippi in Macedonia, where Brutus and Cassius died by their own hands.
3. Trace the distance between those two points.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Eleven: Parts One - Three p.70-74 and Lesson Twelve: Parts One - Epilogue p.77-82

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" and "What else?" Keep

• CHARACTERS

-**Brutus (BROO-tuss):** wanted to preserve the Roman Republic and allied with a group of senators to murder Caesar

-**Tillius Cimber (TIL-ee-us, SIM-ber):** called Metellus Cimber in Shakespeare's play

-**Casca (KAS-kuh):** struck the first blow in the murder of Caesar

-**Octavius Caesar (ok-TAY-vee-us, SEE-zer):** later known as Caesar Augustus



Term 1

narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ **DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR: PICK 1**

You are a senator who walked out when Caesar refused to stand up to greet you. You said nothing. You just left. What were you communicating, and do you think he understood it?

You are Caesar in the moment before you cover your face and give up. You have fought off the others. You are still standing. And then you see Brutus. Something finally stops all the fight in you. You have outrun everything your whole life. What is it that you are finally deciding to stop outrunning (p.78)?

→ **WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE): PICK 1**

You have served Caesar since his early campaigns. You have watched him win in Gaul, survive civil war, defeat Pompey, and return to Rome in triumph. He is now planning new campaigns as if none of it had happened. What does it feel like to follow a man who cannot stop? What do you think he is still looking for?

The crowd killed Cinna the poet because he had the same name as Cinna the conspirator. He tried to tell them who he was, and it made no difference. Think about a situation where a person was judged entirely by something they had no control over. What does that kind of mistake reveal about what happens to people's judgment when they are driven by grief or rage (p.80)?

WEEK 11 **15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker**

Tracker:

News source of your choice
PREP: Preview news source

→ **INTRO**

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ **LOCATE**

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ **NOTEBOOK**

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 12 **25m Ethics: Part 2 - Lesson 12**

Exam Week

→ **EXAMS**

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
Ourselves

Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 12 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 12 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Reading PDF	
WEEK 12 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 12 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: The Plutarch Project Volume 3	
WEEK 12 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course.	

Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 1 25m Ethics: Part 2 - Lesson 13

Materials: Ourselves: Book 1

→ NOTE

Be sure to narrate in a variety of ways.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.IV p.95-96 "Sympathy with One," - "touch of this key."

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Update character traits chart. Think of a new habit you would like to cultivate and create a tracking chart.

• COMPOSITION - Letter

Show sympathy to someone you know by sharing your interest in music, poetry, art, or anything that gives you joy.

WEEK 1 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 13

A Young Nation: American Government from 1800 to 1900

Materials: Reading PDF Part 1

→ INTRO

Welcome back to American Government! Last year, you learned about the formation of the American Government and the reasoning behind why the Constitution and Bill of Rights were drafted and negotiated as they were. This year, we move forward to the period from 1800 to 1900 and study how the new government began to take action and shape the first hundred years of our country's history.

→ READ

∞ Link: Reading PDF Part 1
Week 1

• With any time that you have remaining, read your summary statements and skim any written narrations from the last two years of American Government. Your summary statements should cover the time periods from Rotation 1 (800-1650 AD) and Rotation 2 (1650-1800 AD).

→ REFLECT

Talk about the summary statements you have reviewed with your teacher or classmates. What did you remember? What had you forgotten? Did anything come to mind as you were reviewing that you had not thought about before?

★ TEACHER NOTE

One week is built in at the end of this term for "catch-up" reading, in case you miss a week or a reading takes you longer than your allotted time to complete. Please do not skip ahead if you have not completed the lesson from the week before – work through the weeks chronologically and use the catch-up week (Week 11) as necessary.

Optional Activity: Guide students in creating a bulleted list of keywords that they notice while reading their summary statements or during their discussion. Keywords can be words that were repeated frequently, or that stood out to the student for any particular reason (there is no "right" set of keywords). This activity is optional because it requires students to exercise a higher-level analysis and might not be a useful reflective tool for all students.

WEEK 1 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 13

Agis and Cleomenes

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP:

We highly recommend reading a retelling so you can be familiar with the story. This is for your understanding and should not be read to the students.

∞ Link: Our Young Folks' Plutarch - Agis

∞ Link: Our Young Folks' Plutarch - Cleomenes

• Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ VIEW

∞ Link: Agis Video

→ INTRO

• CHARACTERS

-**Agis (AY-jis):** young king of Sparta

-**Agisilaus #1 (uh-JESS-uh-LAY-uhs):** former king of Sparta

-**Pausanias (paw-SAY-nee-uhs):** general and regent to the king in the 5th century

-**Seleucus (suh-LOO-kuhs):** a former general of Alexander the Great

-**Lycurgus #1 (lie-KUR-gus):** according to legend, was the lawgiver of Sparta

Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

Have you ever heard of Sparta? If so, what do you know about it? What do you think made Sparta different from other ancient Greek cities?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.7

1. Find Sparta in the southern part of Greece, tucked between the Laconian Gulf to the east and the Messenian Gulf to the west.
2. Now find Laconia, the region surrounding Sparta, and Messenia to its west.
3. Find Corinth at the narrow neck of land connecting the southern peninsula to the rest of Greece.
4. Agis's story takes place in this region.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Introduction and Lesson One: Parts One - Two p.84-93 and Lesson Two: Parts One - Three p.96-99

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" and "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR: PICK 1

Agis is not yet twenty years old. He has grown up with wealth and comfort provided by his mother and grandmother, the richest women in Sparta. Plutarch says he "began to spurn against these womanish delights and pleasures" and chose the plain Spartan life instead. Nobody made him do this. What do you think happened inside him, and what does his choice tell you about what kind of person he was becoming (p.91)?

Agis's mother and grandmother were the richest women in Sparta and had the most to lose from his reforms. They opposed him at first. Then something changed, and they not only consented but became his most vocal supporters, willing to give up their own wealth for his cause. What do you think changed their minds? What does their behavior tell you about those women (p.96)?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE): PICK 1

Agis "openly boasted besides, that he would not desire to be king, but only for the hope he had to restore the ancient Laconian life by his authority" (p.91). What do you think he meant?

Agesilaus persuaded Agis to cancel the debts first and divide the land later, arguing that doing both at once might cause dangerous commotion. Then, Plutarch reveals his motives, "Agasilaus...having the best lands of any man in the country, and owing a great sum of money besides, would neither pay his debts, nor let go his land" (p.99). Think about the difference between counsel and manipulation. How do you learn to tell the difference when someone gives you advice?

-**Lysander (ly-SAN-der)**: not the famous general, just named similarly

-**Agasilaus #2 (uh-JESS-uh-LAY-uhs)**: also spelled Agylaeus, was the uncle of Agis

-**Ptolemy III, #1 (TAH-luh-mee)**: the king of Egypt

-**Cleombrotus (klee-OM-broh-tēs)**: king and son-in-law of Leonidas

WEEK 1 ☐ 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice
PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 2 25m Ethics: Part 2 - Lesson 14

Materials: Ourselves: Book 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.IV p.96-97 "A Lever to Raise." - "easily discerned."

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Update habits log. Start a chart where you can list desirable human character traits on one side and their daemons on the other.

• ILLUSTRATE

Draw a scene in which a person shows Sympathy by empathizing with someone who is suffering.

WEEK 2 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 14

Western Expansion and the Missouri Compromise (1820)

Materials: Reading PDF Part 1

→ INTRO

The United States nearly doubled in size following the purchase of the Louisiana Territory from France. As new states began to petition Congress for entry to the country, the issue of slavery began to divide the nation. In 1820, Congress passed the Missouri Compromise, defining geographical boundaries that would determine whether slavery would be legal in new states. The Compromise would be followed by a series of legislative acts that together attempted to bind the new country together in the face of rapid land expansion and deep divides over slavery.

→ READ

∞ Link: Reading PDF Part 1
Week 2

→ REFLECT

Narrate. Write a summary statement or short narration describing the main ideas from this week's reading.

WEEK 2 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 14

Agis and Cleomenes

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.7

1. Find Megara and Corinth.
2. The narrow strip of land between them is the Isthmus of Corinth, where the sea presses in from both sides (the Saronic Gulf and the Gulf of

★ TEACHER NOTE

This week's lesson may feel heavy for some students. An honorable man dies with integrity.

• CHARACTERS

-Aratus (uh-RAY-tuhs): elected general of the Achaean League seventeen times



Term 2

Corinth). The large peninsula below Corinth is the Peloponnese.
3. Neither label appears on this map, but you can see the shape clearly. Sparta is in the Southern Peloponnese region. This is the route Agis marched north with his young army to assist the Achaeans.

→ **VIEW & PRACTICE**
Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ **READ & NARRATE**
Lesson Three: Parts One - Three p.102-106

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" and "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ **DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR**
Agis was led to his death by men pretending to be his friends. When the moment came, he saw a sergeant weeping for him and said, "Good fellow, I pray thee weep not for me, for I am honestest man that so shamefully put me to death" (p.106). He was twenty years old. What do you notice about that moment?

→ **WRITE**
When the ephor asked if Agis repented of what he had done, he answered that "he would never repent him of so wise and virtuous an enterprise, though he ventured his life for it" (p.105-106). What do you think about that answer?

WEEK 2 **15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker**
Tracker:

News source of your choice
PREP: Preview news source

→ **INTRO**
Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**
News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ **LOCATE**
Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ **NOTEBOOK**
Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 3 **25m Ethics: Part 2 - Lesson 15**

Materials: Ourselves: Book 1

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**
Ch.IV p.98 "Tact." - "Vanity, Dislike, Antipathy."

→ **CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK**
Update habits log and character traits chart.

- **COMPOSITION** - Expository
How is egotism a foe of Sympathy? Include examples.

Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 3 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 15

Western Expansion and the Compromise of 1850

Materials: Reading PDF Part 1

→ INTRO

Although the Missouri Compromise remained in effect, the acquisition of the western territory from Texas to modern-day California following the Mexican-American War reignited the question of whether new states formed from this territory would be admitted as slave states or free states. In order to maintain a tentative balance of slave to free states across the nation, Congress passed the Compromise of 1850 after efforts to ban slavery entirely from the new territory failed.

→ READ

∞ Link: Reading PDF Part 1
Week 3

→ REFLECT

Narrate. Write a summary statement or short narration describing the main ideas from this week's reading.

WEEK 3 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 15

Agis and Cleomenes

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: Cleomenes Video

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.7
Find Sparta. That's where this lesson takes place.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Four: Parts One - Two p.109-111

• Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" and "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

Cleomenes married Agiatis against her will, yet "immediately after he was married unto her, fell greatly in fancy with her, and for compassion's sake he thanked her for the love she bore unto her first husband" (p.109). What does that tell you about him?

→ WRITE

Plutarch says Cleomenes and Agis were alike in many ways, but that Cleomenes had "something of heat and passion always goading him on, and an impetuosity and violence in his eagerness to pursue anything which he thought good and just" (p.109). Do you think that is a strength or a weakness? Explain your answer.

• CHARACTERS

-Archidamus (AAR-kih-DAY-mus): second in line to the Agiad throne

-Sphaerus (SFEE-rus): a Stoic philosopher

-Zeno of Citium (ZEE-noh, SISH-ee-um): founder of the Stoic school of philosophy



Term 2

WEEK 3 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker Tracker: News source of your choice PREP: Preview news source → INTRO Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news). → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS News story • What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible? → LOCATE Look at a map and find where the events occurred → NOTEBOOK Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.	
WEEK 4 25m Ethics: Part 2 - Lesson 16 Materials: Ourselves: Book 1 → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.V p.99-100 "That best portion" - "who come in their way." • For your narration, illustrate and caption three examples of the kindness of courtesy.	• CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK Update habits log and character traits chart this week.
WEEK 4 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 16 Western Expansion and the Kansas-Nebraska Act Materials: Reading PDF Part 1 → INTRO The Kansas-Nebraska Act of 1854 repealed the Missouri Compromise in its entirety and allowed the new territories of Kansas and Nebraska to decide the question of whether slavery would be allowed in the territories by popular sovereignty – by a vote of the people of the territories. Violence stemming from pro-slavery and abolitionist clashes in Kansas and in Washington, D.C., earned the nickname “Bleeding Kansas” and foreshadowed the start of the Civil War. → READ ∞ Link: Reading PDF Part 1 Week 4 → REFLECT Consider the three major pieces of Congressional legislation that you have studied over the last three weeks: the Missouri Compromise, the Compromise of 1850, and the Kansas-Nebraska Act. Why do you think that Representatives and Senators in Congress increasingly decided to turn the slavery question over to popular vote? What benefits are there to a popular vote? What drawbacks or dangers might there be to a popular vote?	



Term 2

- Write a summary statement or short narration explaining your thoughts in response to these questions.

WEEK 4 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 16

Agis and Cleomenes

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.7

1. Find Arcadia, the highland region in the center of the peninsula.
2. Find Argos to its east and Mantinea within it.
3. This is the terrain Cleomenes is moving through in this lesson.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Five: Parts One - Four p.114-117

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" and "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

Plutarch says that when Archidamus was murdered, Cleomenes and his friends "were most blamed, as having forced his consent" (p.115). What do you think that means?

→ WRITE

After killing Lydiadas in battle, Cleomenes "caused it to be brought unto him, and putting a purple robe upon it, and a crown on his head, sent it in this array unto the very gates of the city of Megalopolis" (p.116). What does that tell you about Cleomenes?

• CHARACTERS

-Lydiadas (li-DYE-uh-dus): former ruler of Megalopolis, elected general of the Achaean League three times

-Aristomachus (uh-RIS-tuh-MAH-kus): newly elected general of the Achaean League

-Agesilaus #2 (uh-JESS-uh-LAY-uhs): uncle of Agis

WEEK 4 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker

Tracker: [][][][][]

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 5 25m Ethics: Part 2 - Lesson 17

📄 Materials: Ourselves: Book 1

→ READ & NARRATE

Ch.V p.100-101

"Simplicity." - "-- Wordsworth."

→ DISCUSS

- Can there be kindness without simplicity?

• CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Update habits log and character traits chart.

WEEK 5 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 17

Treaties and the Removal of Tribal Nations (Part I)

📄 Materials: Reading PDF Part 1

→ INTRO

Treaties are a tool that the Constitution allows the President to use in order to make formal agreements between the United States and another nation. Over the first four decades of the 19th century, the United States began to engage in treaty-making with American Indian Tribes, located in what are now the southern states of Tennessee, Alabama, Georgia, Florida, and Mississippi, with the goal of removing these Tribes from the South and relocating them west of the Mississippi River.

→ READ

∞ Link: Reading PDF Part 1

Week 5

→ REFLECT

Narrate. Write a summary statement or short narration describing the main ideas from this week's reading.

WEEK 5 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 17

Agis and Cleomenes

📄 Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

📄 Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.7

1. Find Sparta.

2. Now find the surrounding region of Laconia. To the north is Arcadia, to the east is Argolis, to the west is Messenia.

3. These are the regions Cleomenes must hold together as king.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Six: Parts One - Two p.119-122

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" and "What else?" Keep

• CHARACTERS

-**Cleomenes (Klee-OM-in-eez):** the last of the reforming Spartan kings

-**Sphaerus the Philosopher (SFEE-rus):** a Stoic philosopher

-**Eucleidas (yoo-KLY-dēs):** ruled with his brother Cleomenes

Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are a citizen of Sparta watching Cleomenes give his speech and then immediately give up all his own wealth before asking anyone else to. "Himself first, with his step-father, Megistonus, and his friends, gave up all their wealth into one public stock, and all the other citizens followed the example" (p.120). What do you think about that?

→ WRITE

Cleomenes believed "there was no other difference betwixt a friend and a mercenary: but that the one is won with money, and the other with civility and good entertainment" (p.122). Do you agree?

WEEK 5 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker

Tracker:

News source of your choice
PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 6 25m Ethics: Part 2 - Lesson 18

Materials: Ourselves: Book 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.V p.101-102
"Kindness in Construction." - "-- Herbert."

- What are the effects of a kind construction and those of an ungentle construction.? Give examples.

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Update character traits chart. Think of a new habit you would like to cultivate and create a tracking chart.

WEEK 6 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 18

Treaties and the Removal of Tribal Nations (Part II)

Materials: Reading PDF Part 1

→ INTRO

With the Indian Removal Act of 1830, Congress indicated its support for the removal of tribes, specifically authorizing then-President Andrew Jackson to use treaties to effect land exchanges, trading land west of the Mississippi to tribes in exchange for tribal land in the South. But was the

Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

Indian Removal Act constitutional, and were the treaties themselves enforceable? We will explore the Act and its impact further in this week's reading.

→ READ

∞ Link: Reading PDF Part 1
Week 6

→ REFLECT

Narrate. Write a summary statement or short narration describing the main ideas from this week's reading.

WEEK 6 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 18

Agis and Cleomenes

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.7

1. Find Corinth at the top of the Peloponnese.
2. Find Argos to its south.
3. Find the Isthmus of Corinth (see Lesson 15). Cleomenes is moving across the northern Peloponnese, winning city after city, until the question of the Isthmus becomes the question of Greece.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Seven: Parts One - Two p.124-127

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

Plutarch pauses the story to say he writes about Aratus's failure "not out of any design to disgrace Aratus, for in many things he showed himself a true lover of Greece, and a great man; but to make us see the frailty and weakness of man's nature" (p.126). He is telling you directly how to read what just happened. What does it mean when the biographer steps into the story and tells you what to think? Does it change how you receive it?

→ WRITE

You are a Greek citizen watching Aratus bring Antigonos and the Macedonians into the Peloponnese. Plutarch calls it "a practice far dishonest for a Grecian, very infamous for himself, but most dishonourable for the former noble acts he had done" (p.126). What do you think about that?

• CHARACTERS

-Hyperbatas (hy-PUR-buh-tuhs):
general of the Achaean League

-Antigonos (an-TIG-uh-nus):
king of Macedon

WEEK 6 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker

Tracker: □ □ □ □ □ □

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 7 25m Ethics: Part 2 - Lesson 19

Materials: Ourselves: Book 1

→ READ & NARRATE

Ch.VI p.103-104

"Generous Impulses" - "the generous man."

→ DISCUSS

What are some generous movements in history?

• CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Update habits log and character traits chart.

• COMPOSITION - Timeline

Make a timeline of 6-8 generous movements in history.

WEEK 7 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 19

Tribal Nations before the Supreme Court

Materials: Reading PDF Part 2

→ INTRO

While President Jackson and Congress worked to remove Tribes from the South by means of treaties and federal legislation, the Cherokee Nation sought to enforce its treaty rights before the Supreme Court. Over the course of two decisions within the span of the same number of years, the Supreme Court set precedent that would define the rights and status of Tribes into the modern day, and by extension, undermined the integrity of the federal government's treaty-making with these Tribes. The Indian Appropriations Act, passed in 1871 by Congress, would end treaty-making with Tribes altogether.

→ READ

∞ Link: Reading PDF Part 2

Week 7

→ REFLECT

Narrate. Write a summary statement or short narration describing the main ideas from this week's reading.

WEEK 7 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 19

Agis and Cleomenes

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

• CHARACTERS

-Megistonus (meh-GISS-tuh-nus): Cleomenes's stepfather



Term 2

🗺 Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.7

1. Find Corinth, Sicyon, and Argos.
2. Now trace south to Sparta.
3. Cleomenes had made himself "master of all Peloponnesus, and now lost all again in as short a time" (p.132, The Plutarch Project Volume 3).

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Eight: Parts One - Four p.129-133

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" and "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are one of the men retreating with Cleomenes when news arrives that his wife has died. Plutarch says, "he gave not place unto his sorrow, neither did grief overcome his noble courage, but he used the selfsame voice, apparel, and countenance, that he did before" (p.133). What do you think about that?

→ WRITE

You are in Argos when the city revolts against Cleomenes because he was "not releasing them from their debts as they expected" (p.132). What do you think about that?

WEEK 7 🗓 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker

Tracker: 📅 📅 📅 📅 📅

News source of your choice
PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 8 🗓 25m Ethics: Part 2 - Lesson 20

📖 Materials: Ourselves: Book 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.VI p.105 "Generosity is Costly," - "his own family."

- Explain how generosity is both costly and profitable.

Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Update habits log and character traits chart.

WEEK 8 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 20

Congress & Southern Secession

Materials: Reading PDF Part 2

→ INTRO

On December 20, 1860, South Carolina seceded from the United States. Over the next seven months, ten more states would follow suit. Four of these states drafted formal Declarations of Causes that set forth their justifications for secession. This week, we will explore these Declarations in more detail and consider the impact that southern secession had on the federal Congress the states left behind.

→ READ

∞ Link: Reading PDF Part 2
Week 8

→ REFLECT

Consider how the various southern secession documents compare or contrast with the Declaration of Independence. What strikes you as similar or different? Among other things, you want to think about the organization or length of the documents, the reasons given for separation, and the historical events occurring at the time that each document was signed.

- Write a summary statement or short narration describing the main ideas from this week's reading.

★ TEACHER NOTE

If you have a group of students, pose this question for group discussion as an alternative to traditional narration. If you are the only student in your class, jot down some of the similarities or differences that you think of.

WEEK 8 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 20

Agis and Cleomenes

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.7

1. Find Megalopolis in Arcadia.
2. Now find the middle prong of the peninsula between the Messenian Gulf and the Laconian Gulf. The tip of that prong, not labeled on this map, is Taenarus, where Cratesiclea boarded a ship for Egypt.
3. Find Cythera, the small island just off that tip.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Nine: Parts One - Two p.135-138

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" and "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are one of the soldiers who watched Cleomenes take Megalopolis. He

★ TEACHER NOTE

"Ptolemy (#1)...promised him aid, but upon demand to have his mother and children in pledge."

Important Vocabulary - in pledge: as hostages.

1. They were collateral: They were the price for ships and money.

2. They were high-ranking: Only the King's own mother and children were valuable enough to secure the alliance.

3. They were voluntary (in spirit): Cratesiclea views herself not as a victim, but as a Spartan citizen fulfilling a mission that is "profitable for Sparta."

• CHARACTERS

-**Philopoemen (fil-oh-PEE-men):** leader of the Achaean League

-**Ptolemy III, #1 (TAH-luh-mee):** king of Egypt, died soon after Cleomenes's arrival

-**Panteus (PAN-tee-us):** friend of Cleomenes

Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

had "taken strict care that the city should not be plundered" before offering it back to its citizens. When they refused, he destroyed it (p.138). What do you think about what you witnessed?

→ WRITE

You are standing at the temple door, watching Cratesiclea say goodbye to her son before boarding a ship for Egypt as a hostage. She tells him, "O King of Lacedaemon, let no man see for shame, when we come out of the temple, that we have wept and dishonoured Sparta. For that only is in our power, and for the rest, as it pleaseth the gods, so let it be" (p.135). What do you think about what she chose to say?

WEEK 8 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker

Tracker:

News source of your choice
PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 9 25m Ethics: Part 2 - Lesson 21

Materials: Ourselves: Book 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.VI p.106-107 "Fallacious Notions" - "--- Lowell."

• CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Update habits log and character traits chart this week.

- COMPOSITION - Outline
Outline the three false notions that prevent generosity.

WEEK 9 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 21

Congress & the Reconstruction Acts

Materials: Reading PDF Part 2

→ INTRO

Following the end of the Civil War and preliminary reconstruction efforts by President Johnson, Congress exerted control over the Reconstruction project by passing a series of acts now known as the Reconstruction Acts. These Acts, passed over a presidential veto by Johnson, established military control in southern states that had seceded and established strict standards for readmission to the Union.

→ READ

∞ Link: Reading PDF Part 2
Week 9

Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

→ REFLECT

Narrate. Write a summary statement or short narration describing the main ideas from this week's reading.

WEEK 9 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 21

Agis and Cleomenes

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.7

1. Find Argos and the territory around it, where Cleomenes marched twice to shame Antigonus into fighting or force him to lose face.
2. Now find Sellasia, just north of Sparta. This is where the final battle took place, almost within sight of home.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Ten: Parts One - Three p.139-143

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" and "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are fighting beside Cleomenes at Sellasia when his brother's flank collapses. You hear him cry out, "Alas, good brother, thou art but slain, yet thou diest valiantly, and honestly, and thy death shall be a worthy example unto all posterity" (p.142). He is still fighting when he says it. Why do you think Plutarch chose to record his exact words?

→ WRITE

You are one of the men who retreated with Cleomenes from Sellasia. You watched him walk back into Sparta, advise the citizens to yield, lean against a pillar to collect his thoughts, and then sail away. What do you think about the man you followed (p.143)?

• CHARACTERS

-Polybius (puh-LIB-ee-uhs): a historian, one of Plutarch's sources

WEEK 9 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 10 25m Ethics: Part 2 - Lesson 22

Materials: Ourselves: Book 1

→ READ & NARRATE

Ch.VII p.108-109 "The Gladness of a Grateful" - "value to us."

→ DISCUSS

Do you have a relative or friend from whom you have received double joys?

• CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Update habits log and character traits chart this week.

• COMPOSITION - Letter

Write a letter to a relative or friend from whom you have received double joys. Acknowledge and thank them for at least three kindnesses.

WEEK 10 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 22

"Defective from the Start": The Constitution, Slavery, & the Civil War Amendments

Materials: Reading PDF Part 2

→ INTRO

In addition to taking control of Reconstruction following the close of the Civil War, Congress also proposed three amendments to the Constitution. These amendments, now known as the Civil War Amendments, banned slavery and established a series of protections and rights that are now foundational to how we think about citizenship in the United States. It would be five years before these amendments were fully ratified by the states, and it would be nearly a hundred more years until the Civil Rights Movement would take up the vision for justice and equality that these amendments had begun to advance.

→ READ

∞ Link: Reading PDF Part 2
Week 10

→ REFLECT

Narrate. Write a summary statement or short narration describing the main ideas from this week's reading.

WEEK 10 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 22

Agis and Cleomenes

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.10-11

1. Find the Peloponnesus (p.10, Alexander's Empire).
2. From the southeastern tip of that peninsula, trace a line southeast across the open Mediterranean Sea, passing just to the west of the island of Crete, until you reach Libya and Alexandria on the coast of Egypt.

This is the voyage Cleomenes made after his final defeat at Sellasia. He left behind everything he knew to arrive at a foreign court in Alexandria to ask for help from a king who owed him nothing.

★ TEACHER NOTE

Therycion's speech and Cleomenes's reply are a genuine philosophical debate, not a simple case of one man being right and one wrong. Therycion is not a coward; he is making an argument about honor and the limits of hope. Cleomenes is not dismissing death; he is making an argument about the difference between dying with purpose and dying to escape. Let students sit with the difficulty of that before asking who they think is right.

• CHARACTERS

-Ptolemy IV, #2 (TAH-luh-mee): king who mistrusted Cleomenes and was responsible for the deaths of his own mother and

Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Eleven: Parts One - Three p.145-148

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" and "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are standing on the deck of a ship looking back at the disappearing coast of Greece. The war is lost. Your home is occupied. Therycion turns to you, hand on his sword, and argues that living as a "fugitive" in Egypt is a fate worse than death. Cleomenes disagrees, calling suicide a "cowardly" escape from the hard work of hope. Discuss both sides of the argument. Do you think one of these men is correct (p.145-146)?

→ WRITE

"King Ptolemy (#1), at his first coming, gave Cleomenes no special good, but indifferent entertainment. But when, upon trial, he found him a man of deep sense and great reason...conversation carried with it a noble and becoming grace...he was ashamed, and repented that he had neglected so great a man" (p.146-147). Is firsthand experience the only way to judge a person's character? Does our character only count when we communicate it well to others?

brother

-**Sosibius (soh-SIB-ee-us):**
Ptolemy's chief minister

WEEK 10 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker

Tracker:

News source of your choice
PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 11 25m Ethics: Part 2 - Lesson 23

Materials: Ourselves: Book 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.VII p.110-111 "The Reproach of Ingratitude" - "thankful!"

- Describe the sin of ingratitude. What examples from your books can you think of that illustrate this sin?

Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Write a brief reflection on how you did with habit cultivation this term.

WEEK 11 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 23

Catch-Up Day

Materials: Reading PDF Part 2

→ CATCH UP

Catch up on any reading you have not completed for this term. Review your summary statements in chronological order so that you have a complete picture of how our readings relate to each other.

WEEK 11 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 23

Agis and Cleomenes

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.10-11

Find Alexandria in Egypt. This is where the entire final lesson takes place.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Twelve: Parts One - Three p.149-153

• Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" and "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are one of the thirteen Spartans. Why would you choose to "die like a man" in a foreign street rather than surrender and try to live (p.152)? What did Cleomenes understand in this moment about the difference between giving someone liberty and that person being capable of being free? Can a person be given freedom if they are already commanded by their own love of ease and safety?

→ WRITE

Panteus was the last to die. Cleomenes had commanded him to check each fallen man and die last of all. He did exactly that: walked among his friends, tested each one, and then fell on Cleomenes and slew himself. Think about what it means to be given one last duty by someone you loved and to carry it out after they are already gone. What does faithfulness look like at the very end of everything?

★ TEACHER NOTE

This is the end of two lives; Agis's half of the story ended in Lesson Three. Now Cleomenes's ends here. Ask students to look back across both men before discussing: what did they share, where did they differ, and what does Plutarch seem to think each man's story teaches?

• CHARACTERS

-**Ptolemy #3 (TAH-luh-mee)**: son of Chrysermus, another Ptolemy

-**Ptolemy #4 (TAH-luh-mee)**: governor of Alexandria, another Ptolemy

WEEK 11 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO



Term 2	
Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news). → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS News story • What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible? → LOCATE Look at a map and find where the events occurred → NOTEBOOK Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.	
WEEK 12 25m Ethics: Part 2 - Lesson 24 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: Ourselves	
WEEK 12 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 24 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Reading PDF	
WEEK 12 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 24 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: The Plutarch Project Volume 3	
WEEK 12 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course.	

Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 1 25m Ethics: Part 2 - Lesson 25

Materials: Ourselves: Book 1

→ NOTE

Be sure to narrate in a variety of ways.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.VIII p.112-115

"We all have Courage." - "the unbelieving."

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Update character traits chart. Think of a new habit you would like to cultivate and create a tracking chart.

• COMPOSITION

Tell how we are able to "take the present without any fearful looking forward." Provide three examples.

WEEK 1 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 25

Materials: Dollars & Sense, Citizenship notebook

→ INTRO

Are you familiar with the Bible verse, "The love of money is a root of all kinds of evil" (I Timothy 6:10)? What do you think that means, and how have you seen that truth play out? This term, we will be studying economics, which has to do with money and the way a country uses and produces goods and services.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Introduction ix-xiii "Bread. Dough." - "dollars and cents."
2. p.8 "You've Got It and I Want It: The Law of Supply and Demand"

- How does money help the economy, and how does greed hurt the economy?

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

∞ Video Link: What is Supply and Demand?

- Explain the economic principle "The Law of Supply and Demand."

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK (MAKE A SECTION IN YOUR NOTEBOOK OR BINDER CALLED ECONOMICS)

1. Make a list of the goods and services your family uses that contribute toward a healthy economy. Goods are tangible things you buy, such as clothes and food. Services are intangible and usually involve paying for a business to do something for you. Examples: haircuts, car insurance, phone service.
2. Can you think of examples that fit the economic principle of the Law of Supply and Demand? Also, make a list of items that may be in high demand or low demand depending on the time of year.

WEEK 1 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 25

Tiberius and Gaius Gracchus

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP:

- We highly recommend reading a retelling so you can be familiar with the story. This is for your understanding and should not be read to the students.
- ∞ Link: Our Young Folks' Plutarch - Tiberius Gracchus
- ∞ Link: Our Young Folks' Plutarch - Caius Gracchus
- Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

• CHARACTERS

-**Scipio #1 (SKIP-ee-oh):** Roman general and grandfather of Tiberius and Gaius

-**Scipio #2 (SKIP-ee-oh):** adopted grandson of Scipio #1, destroyer of the city of Carthage

-**King Ptolemy VIII (TAH-luh-mee):** king of Egypt

-**Appius Claudius (AP-ee-uhs, CLAW-dee-uhs):** consul



Term 3

→ VIEW

- ∞ Image Link: Tiberius and Caius Gracchus
- ∞ Video Link: Tiberius Video
- ∞ Video Link: Gaius Video

→ LOCATE

📍 Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

1. Find Rome in the center of Italy.
2. Locate Carthage in North Africa.
3. Tiberius and Gaius Gracchus were the grandsons of Scipio Africanus, the Roman commander who defeated Hannibal at the Battle of Zama in 202 BC.
4. Notice the distance between Rome and Africa; this family's influence spanned the Mediterranean world before the boys were even born.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson One: Prologue - Part Two p.160-163

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" and "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are a Roman citizen watching the two brothers walk through the Forum. Read the descriptions of the brothers on pages 161 and 162. Which brother would you trust more to lead a revolution, and why?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

Plutarch notes that Cornelia's education of her sons "prevailed more than nature" (p.161). Do you think a person's upbringing can entirely change their natural temperament?

WEEK 1 📅 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice
PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 2 25m Ethics: Part 2 - Lesson 26

Materials: Ourselves: Book 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.VIII p.115-116 "The Courage of our Opinions." - "elders."

- Give your opinion on any topic of interest. Do you think your opinion is based on knowledge and principle which you possess, or is it based on what everybody says?

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Update habits log. Start a chart where you can list desirable human character traits on one side and their daemons on the other.

WEEK 2 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 26

Materials: Dollars & Sense, Citizenship notebook

→ RECAP

What do you remember about last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.1 p.1-9 "Have you ever" - "the ancient world."

- Why did the bartering system need to be replaced with something better?

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

- ∞ Image Link: Cowrie shells (used as money in ancient China)
- ∞ Image Link: Deerskin used as folding money (China)
- ∞ Image Link: Chinese paper money
- ∞ Image Link: Fort Knox

- Talk about the different items used before money and why they didn't work out.

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Make a timeline and draw pictures with labels to show the different mediums of exchange from ancient times to the present day. Look at p.4-5 to help you fill out the timeline. There are links to see some of the different mediums that were used.

WEEK 2 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 26

Tiberius and Gaius Gracchus

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

1. Find Carthage, where Tiberius "was first to mount the walls" (p.165).
2. Find Numantia in the northern part of Hither Spain. This is rugged, difficult territory.
3. Trace the long route from Rome, across the sea, and into the Spanish mountains. This is where Tiberius saved 20,000 Roman lives.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

• CHARACTERS

-Fannius (FAN-ee-us): an orator and historian

-Gaius Mancinus (GUY-us man-SEE-nus): consul, captured by Numantines, returned to Rome, but stripped of his seat in the Senate

Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Two: Parts One - Two p.165-167

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" and "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are a Roman soldier trapped in the mountains of Numantia. Your Consul has failed, and you are surrounded. The enemies refuse to speak to anyone but Tiberius Gracchus. How does it feel to have your life depend on the reputation of one young officer (p.165)?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

You are a Numantine governor. You have just captured the Roman army's entire payroll and the young officer's records. Your people hate Rome. Why do you treat this specific young man like a guest of honor instead of a prisoner of war (p.166)?

WEEK 2 ☐ 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice
PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 3 ☐ 25m Ethics: Part 2 - Lesson 27

☐ Materials: Ourselves: Book 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.VIII p.116-117 "The Courage" - "faithful souls."

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Update habits log and character traits chart.

- COMPOSITION - Persuasive
Show that intellectual panic is responsible for many failures.
Give three examples.

WEEK 3 ☐ 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 27

☐ Materials: Dollars & Sense, Historical Atlas of the World

→ RECAP

What do you remember about last week's reading?

- IMPORTANT DATES
Founding of the order the Knights Templar (1119 AD)



Term 3

→ LOCATE

📍 Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World

- On p.8, find Mesopotamia and Babylon. What present-day countries are located there?
- On p.30-31, find Jerusalem, Edessa, Antioch, and Tripoli. Now, find Florence, Italy. These are places that we will read about today that have to do with an early form of banking.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Ch.2 p.11-19 "Where do you keep" - "Hard work."
2. p.12 "An Eye for an Eye"
3. p.14 "You Can't Take it With You"

- What banking practices from history are still used today?

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

∞ Image Link: The Knights Templar

- How did the Knights Templar help the Pilgrims while traveling to Jerusalem?

WEEK 3 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 27

Tiberius and Gaius Gracchus

📄 Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

📍 Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

1. Find Rome.
2. Now, trace a line with your finger northward along the western coast toward the Alps. This region (modern-day Tuscany) is where Tiberius looked out at the vast estates.
3. Imagine the "Roman Pink" on your map isn't a country owned by its people, but a giant puzzle where only a few wealthy men own all the pieces.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Three: Parts One - Three p.169-172

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" and "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are a wealthy Senator. You bought land legally (or so you claim) years ago. Now, a young Tribune tells you that you must give it back to the poor. Tiberius says the soldiers "have nothing but air and light" (p.171). How would you respond?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

If you were a soldier who just returned from the wars in Spain, how would you respond to Tiberius's speech (p.171-172)?

• CHARACTERS

-Gaius Laelius (GUY-us, LAY-lee-us): Roman general and friend of Scipio #1

-Mucius Scaevola (MEW-shus, SEV-uh-luh): lawyer, consul, and high priest

Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 3 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice
PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 4 25m Ethics: Part 2 - Lesson 28

Materials: Ourselves: Book 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.IX p.118-120 "Loyalty of Youth." - "a cause of joy."

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Update habits log and character traits chart.

- COMPOSITION - Debate
Are we free to choose our loyalties?

WEEK 4 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 28

Materials: Dollars & Sense, Citizenship notebook

→ RECAP

What do you remember about last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Ch.3 p.21-29 "In early America" - "finally in place."
2. p.22 "Financial Genius: Alexander Hamilton"

- What were some reasons some people were opposed to a national bank?

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

Look at the map on p.27, which shows the locations of Federal Reserve Banks. What bank is your city part of? You can check out this link to see the 12 districts.

∞ Image Link: The Twelve Federal Reserve Districts

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Make a chart showing the information on p.28. You can look at these websites to find additional information, such as the names of the people in charge of the different areas.

∞ Link: Federal Reserve Board

∞ Link: Comptroller of the Currency

• EXTRA HELPING

Watch this 3-minute video on this website that explains the purpose of the Federal Reserve System.

∞ Video Link: Purpose of Federal Reserve System

• IMPORTANT DATES

Establishment of the first national bank of the United States (1791)

The Federal Reserve Banks were established (1913)

Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 4 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 28

Tiberius and Gaius Gracchus

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

Find Rome. Tiberius "sealed up" the gates of the Temple of Saturn in the city of Rome to stop the economy until his law was passed (p.175, The Plutarch Project Volume 3).

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Four: Parts One - Two p.174-177

• Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" and "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are Marcus Octavius, Tiberius's friend and fellow Tribune. You believe the land law is dangerous for Rome's stability. Your best friend is now asking the people to fire you from your job. How would you respond?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

Tiberius and Octavius were "vehement" against each other, but used no "foul words" (p.174). Why do you think Plutarch chose to tell us that?

• CHARACTERS

-Marcus Octavius (MAHR-kuhs, ok-TAY-vee-uhs): orator and elected tribune

-Fulvius #1 (FOOL-vee-us): consul

WEEK 4 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

• What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 5 25m Ethics: Part 2 - Lesson 29

Materials: Ourselves: Book 1

→ READ & NARRATE

Ch.IX p.120-122 "Loyalty to Country." - "on every hand."

- To what cause of your local government are you interested in giving your time, labor, and means to advance it? What can you do to participate and work towards advancing this cause?

→ DISCUSS

To what cause of your local government can you give of your time, labor, and means to advance it?

• CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Update habits log and character traits chart.

WEEK 5 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 29

Materials: Dollars & Sense, Citizenship notebook

PREP: Print out the check template and check register.

∞ Link: Check template

∞ Link: Check register

→ RECAP

What do you remember about last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.4 p.31-41 "Money and power" - "always that way."

- What happens when you write a check for more than you have in your bank account?

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

Explain the graph on p.39. It is based on the idea that you have \$1000 in a savings account.

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

1. Fill out the check template and check register (bank book), and put it in your notebook.
2. Make a list of the types of bank accounts and briefly describe each one. See p.40 for more information.

WEEK 5 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 29

Tiberius and Gaius Gracchus

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

1. Find the Kingdom of Pergamum (in modern-day Turkey/Asia Minor).
2. King Attalus died and left his entire kingdom to Rome. Tiberius wanted to take that royal wealth and give it directly to the poor to buy tools for their new farms. "That made him again more hated of the Senate than before" (p.180, The Plutarch Project Volume 3).

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself

• CHARACTERS

-**Publius Nasica** (POOB-lee-uhs, nuh-SY-kuh): cousin of the Gracchi, also a Pontifex Maximus (chief priest) and consul

-King Attalus of Pergamon (AT-uh-lus, PUR-guh-mon): left his kingdom to the Romans to avoid bloodshed, very scholarly

-**Titus Annius** (TY-tus, AN-ee-us): consul



Term 3

with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ **READ & NARRATE**

Lesson Five: Parts One - Three p.179-182

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" and "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ **DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR**

You are a member of the Senate. Tiberius has just proposed that the inheritance of King Attalus should be "distributed among the poor citizens" to furnish them for their new farms (p.179). How would you respond?

→ **WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)**

Tiberius said, "But when he goeth about to take away the authority and power of the people, then he is no more a tribune" (p.181). Do you agree with that definition of leadership?

WEEK 5 **15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker**

Tracker:

News source of your choice
PREP: Preview news source

→ **INTRO**

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ **LOCATE**

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ **NOTEBOOK**

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 6 **25m Ethics: Part 2 - Lesson 30**

Materials: Ourselves: Book 1

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

Ch.IX p.122-124 "Loyalty to Personal Ties." - "far more."

- "Perhaps there is always more of the best to be had in sticking to that we have got than in looking out continually for a new shop for every sort of ware." Explain this quote. How does this principle of loyalty apply to your life, someone you know, and/or someone about whom you have read?

→ **CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK**

Update character traits chart. Think of a new habit you would like to cultivate and create a tracking chart.

Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 6 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 30

Materials: Dollars & Sense

→ RECAP

What did you read last time in economics?

→ INTRO

Are you familiar with the stock market? What do you know about it?
Before reading chapter 5, please read the section on p.45, "Companies for Sale," to prepare for the reading.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.5 p.44-49 "Inflation. Recession." - "had to be done."

- Describe some of the events that led to the Great Depression

• IMPORTANT DATES

The Stock Market Crash (1929)

WEEK 6 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 30

Tiberius and Gaius Gracchus

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15
Find Rome. Here, "were slain above three hundred men," including Tiberius (p.187, The Plutarch Project Volume 3).

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Six: Parts One - Two p.183-187

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" and "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are a supporter of Tiberius. You see him touch his head to signal he is in danger, but "his enemies, seeing the sign he gave, ran presently to the Senate, and declared that Tiberius desired the people to bestow a crown upon him, as if this were the meaning of his touching his head" (p.186). Suddenly, a mob of Senators comes charging out of the meeting, armed with broken chair legs. Do you stay to fight, or do you flee?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

Tiberius was killed by a fellow Tribune with the "foot of a chair" (p.186). Plutarch notes that not one man was killed with an "iron weapon" (p.187). Why do you think Plutarch pointed this out?

• CHARACTERS

-Blossius (BLOSS-ee-us):
philosopher of Cumae

-Flavius Flaccus (FLAY-vee-us, FLAK-us): supporter of the Gracchi

WEEK 6 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice
PREP: Preview news source

Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 7 25m Ethics: Part 2 - Lesson 31

Materials: Ourselves: Book 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.IX p.124-125 "Thoroughness." - "alien to flight."

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Update habits log and character traits chart.

• COMPOSITION - Cause & Effect

Write about three causes of disloyalty (what loyalty forbids) and their effects. Give an example of each.

WEEK 7 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 31

Materials: Dollars & Sense, Citizenship notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read last time in economics?

→ INTRO

What do you think it would be like to become the President in the middle of the Great Depression?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.5 p.49-53 "Franklin Delano Roosevelt" - "and cannot work."
(You don't need to read the excerpt "Thinking about Money" on p.52. It will be read in the next lesson.)

- What are some things that President Roosevelt did to help the economy? Why did some people not agree with those actions?

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Make a list of some of the economic programs that were part of the New Deal. You can find the information on p.53 and at the following website.
∞ Link: New Deal Programs

• EXTRA HELPING

You can look to see what public works were created in your state as a result of the New Deal which employed thousands of people.
∞ Link: New Deal projects by state

• IMPORTANT DATES

New Deal programs are established by FDR (1933)

WEEK 7 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 31

Tiberius and Gaius Gracchus

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas p.14-15

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

• CHARACTERS

-Aristonicus (uh-riss-tuh-NEE-kus): original name of Eumenes III of Pergamon

-Publius Crassus (POOB-lee-us, KRASS-us): a high priest and consul, father-in-law of Gaius Gracchus

Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

→ LOCATE

□ Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

1. Find Rome in Italy. The Tiber River flows through it, though it is not labeled on this map. This is where the victors threw Tiberius's body, denying him a burial.
2. Now find Sardinia, the island to the southwest. This is where Gaius was sent as Quaestor to keep him away from the political fires in Rome.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Seven: Parts One - Two p.189-191

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" and "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are Gaius Gracchus. Your brother is dead, his friends were executed, and you have just had a dream where Tiberius tells you, "Brother, why dost thou prolong time...we were both predestined to one manner of life and death" (p.191). How do you feel about the dream?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

Plutarch says of Gaius that "some were of opinion that he was more popular, and desirous of the common people's good will and favour, than his brother had been before him" (p.191). Do you think it was a compliment?

-Orestes (oh-REST-eez): consul and then proconsul in Sardinia

WEEK 7 □ 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker

Tracker: □ □ □ □ □

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 8 □ 25m Ethics: Part 2 - Lesson 32

□ Materials: Ourselves: Book 1

→ READ & NARRATE

Ch.X p.126-128 "Pride of Life." - "ourselves for the fact."

- "What we call Humility is often a form of Hypocrisy." Explain this quote.

• CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Update habits log and character traits chart.

Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

Can you think of three examples of your own which illustrate this idea?

→ DISCUSS

What does Mason mean when she says, "What we call Humility is often a form of Hypocrisy"?

WEEK 8 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 32

Materials: Dollars & Sense, Citizenship notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read last time in economics?

→ INTRO

Do you know what a mortgage is? How does it help people buy houses?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.6 p.55-61 "Most people " - "in the future."

- Explain what we mean by a housing bubble and how that was one of the factors that led to the Great Recession.
- On p.61, the author writes, "Once again, Keynesian economics came into play as the US government stepped in to institute large and controversial programs." Go back to p.52 and read the excerpt about the famous economist John Maynard Keynes. Discuss his theories and how they came into play during the Great Recession.

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Make a list of the ways the government stepped in to stimulate the economy during the Great Recession. You can find information in the excerpts on p.60-61.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Great Recession (December 2007-June 2009)

WEEK 8 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 32

Tiberius and Gaius Gracchus

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

1. Find Rome in Italy. The Field of Mars lies just outside its walls, though it is not labeled on this map. Plutarch says so many people came to vote for Gaius that "the Field of Mars not being large enough to hold such a multitude of people, there were that gave their voices upon the top of houses" (p.194, The Plutarch Project Volume 3).

2. Now find Sardinia to the southwest. This is where Gaius "not only excelled all the young men of his age in his actions against his enemies" but also "in temperance, frugality, and industry, he surpassed those who were much older than himself" (p.193).

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Eight: Parts One - Three p.193-197

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" and "What else?" Keep

• CHARACTERS

-King Micipsa (my-KIP-suh): king of Numidia

-Popilius (puh-PIL-ee-uhs): consul

Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are one of the censors hearing Gaius defend himself. He tells you he "alone of all men else that had been in the wars, had carried his purse full, and brought it home empty: where others having drunk the wine which they carried thither in vessels, had afterwards brought them home full of gold and silver" (p.194). What do you think about his defense?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

Plutarch says that where all other orators turned toward the Senate, Gaius, "in contrary manner when he made his oration, turned him outwards towards the other side of the marketplace" (p.196-197). Plutarch calls it "a little turning." What do you think it meant?

WEEK 8 ☐ 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice
PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 9 ☐ 25m Ethics: Part 2 - Lesson 33

☐ Materials: Ourselves: Book 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.X p.128-130 "Humility one with Simplicity." - "-- Trench."

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Update habits log and character traits chart.

- COMPOSITION - Point of View
Imagine you are a parent who is trying to help your teen to recognize and to overcome Pride. What advice would you give your teen? Name 10 actions you would recommend to your teen to get away from the thought of him or herself.

WEEK 9 ☐ 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 33

☐ Materials: Dollars & Sense, Citizenship notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read last time in Economics?

→ INTRO

What would life be like if everyone only bought things they could afford in cash? How could that be a good thing? How could that be a negative thing? What items might be hard to purchase?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.7 p.63-71 "In the first" - "need to do."

Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

- What are the pros and cons of using credit cards?
- What factors affect one's credit score?

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Make a list of the different kinds of real estate loans and include a brief description of each.

WEEK 9 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 33

Tiberius and Gaius Gracchus

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

Find Capua. This was one of the major cities where Gaius wanted to send poor citizens to live.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Nine: Parts One - Two p.199-202

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" and "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

Plutarch writes, "He won the good will of the common people, being more popular and familiar in his conversation and deeds than he was otherwise in his orations" (p.200). Consider the Lives we have studied this year. What role does a person's personality play in their success?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

The Senate has hired a rival, Livius Drusus, to "play the demagogue" and outbid you. While you offer two colonies for the "honestest citizens," he offers twelve colonies for the "poorest," letting them have the land "scot free" (p.201). As Gaius, how do you defend your laws in this situation?

• CHARACTERS

-**Fabius (FAY-bee-uhs)**: vice praetor, governor of Spain, and consul

-**Gaius Fannius (GUY-us, FAN-ee-us)**: consul

-**Livius Drusus (LIV-ee-uhs, DROO-suhs)**: appointed tribune for the sole purpose of counter-offering anything that Gaius Gracchus proposed

WEEK 9 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 10 25m Ethics: Part 2 - Lesson 34

Materials: Ourselves: Book 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.XI p.131-133 "It is a seemly fashion" - "have given away."

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Update habits log and character traits chart.

• **COMPOSITION** - Script
Write a few scenes in which you show through the characters that gladness is catching.

WEEK 10 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 34

Materials: Dollars & Sense, Citizenship notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read last time in Economics?

→ INTRO

Why do you think having a budget is a wise financial practice?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.8 p.73-76 "Money is - "manage your money."

- What is the difference between needs and wants, and how does that affect a budget?
- Many people suggest three categories for budgeting: spending, saving, and giving. What do you think about those 3 categories, and how can you go about implementing that?

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Practice putting together a budget. Use the example on p.74 and create a chart in your notebook. If you don't have your own money or expenses, you can try to put one together to show the expenses of an average household and see what kind of income you would need to cover those expenses.

WEEK 10 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 34

Tiberius and Gaius Gracchus

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

Look at the sea south of Capua. Gaius sailed across this water to Carthage to build a city named "Junonia." While there, a storm blew away his sacrifices, and wolves stole his boundary marks (p.204-205, The Plutarch Project Volume 3).

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions

• CHARACTERS

-**Fulvius (FUL-vee-us)**: aka Flavius Flaccus, supporter of the Gracchi

-**Lucius Opimius (LOO-shus, oh-PIM-ee-us)**: consul

-**Gaius Fannius (GUY-us, FAN-ee-us)**: consul

Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Ten: Parts One - Two p.203-205

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" and "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are Gaius, back in Rome. You see one of your "familiar friends" being dragged to prison by the Consul's officers. You have promised to protect your allies, but you "pass by without assisting him," claiming you don't want to pick a quarrel. What are you thinking (p.205)?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

Plutarch wrote, Gaius "came now to take a house near the marketplace, to show himself nearby the lowlier and more popular" (p.205). Why do you think he moved?

WEEK 10 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice
PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 11 25m Ethics: Part 2 - Lesson 35

☐ Materials: Ourselves: Book 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.XI p.133-135 "Gladness is Perennial." - "I say, rejoice."

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Write a brief reflection on how you did with habit cultivation this term.

• EXTRA HELPINGS

Act out a scene or two in which someone is at a delightful event, but he or she is sullen and unhappy. What was the cause of the person's moodiness? How did it affect his or her time at the event among the other guests? How did it affect other guests?

WEEK 11 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 35

☐ Materials: Dollars & Sense, Citizenship notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read last time in Economics?

→ INTRO

Do you know how much debt the U.S. has? Take a guess. You can find the answer on this website:



Term 3

∞ Link: National Debt

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Ch.8 p.77-83
2. p.78 "The National Debt"
3. p.82 "Getting Down to Basics" and "The Hammer"
4. Conclusion p.85-86

- Why do you think it is so hard to balance the national budget?

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Make a list of some of the items that the federal government spends money on. Make a list of ways the government receives money (revenue). Try brainstorming on your own, and then use these websites to find more information.

∞ Link: Government Spending

∞ Link: Sources of Federal Revenue

WEEK 11 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 35

Tiberius and Gaius Gracchus

📖 Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

📖 Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

1. Look at the city of Rome. The conflict has now moved from laws and speeches to the streets themselves.
2. Visualize the Capitol, where both parties met "by break of day." The peace is broken when an attendant named Antyllus is slain with "great bodkins to write with" rather than swords (p.209, The Plutarch Project Volume 3).

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Eleven: Parts One - Two p.208-211 and Lesson Twelve: Parts One - Epilogue p.212-215

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" and "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR - PICK 1

Plutarch wrote, "Gaius would not arm himself, but went out of his house in a long gown, as if he would have gone simply into the marketplace" (p.210). What do you think about his choices?

You are a guest at Cornelia's home in Misenum. She tells the story of her sons' deaths "without shedding a tear," as if she were telling a history of someone else. Some guests think she has lost her "reason and sense" from grief. Do you agree (p.215)?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE): PICK 1

Gaius' wife says, "Alas, what hope or trust is left us now, in laws or gods, since they have slain Tiberius" (p.211)? What kind of loss do you think she is describing?

The people eventually built statues of the Gracchi and "consecrated the



Term 3	
places where they had been slain." Looking back at their lives, did the Gracchi brothers "win" or "lose" their battle for the Roman people (p.215)? Why?	
WEEK 11 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker Tracker: News source of your choice PREP: Preview news source → INTRO Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news). → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS News story • What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible? → LOCATE Look at a map and find where the events occurred → NOTEBOOK Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.	
WEEK 12 25m Ethics: Part 2 - Lesson 36 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: Ourselves	
WEEK 12 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 36 Materials: Dollars & Sense → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Dollars & Sense	
WEEK 12 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 36 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: The Plutarch Project Volume 3	
WEEK 12 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course.	

Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)

Examination

Term 1

Current Events: Grades 5-8

- Tell the story of one of the news events of this term.

Plutarch: Grades 6-8

- You have followed Caesar from his early campaigns through every battle, every crisis, every triumph, and into Rome at the end. You have watched him grab sailors, swim through fire, feed horses seaweed, pardon enemies, refuse bodyguards, and finally cover his face and stop when he saw Brutus. Looking at the whole of what you witnessed: what did this man actually want, and did he ever get it? OR
You are a Roman citizen who lived through all of it. Caesar was on the wrong side as a young man, nearly drowned escaping, nearly starved at Pharsalus, made himself dictator for life, died in the Senate chamber, and was declared a god three days later. The city burned. The men who killed him were hunted to their deaths. Now it is quiet. Was Rome better or worse for having had him? Why?

American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8

- Reading PDF: Describe your state government as it is created by your state constitution. Include 1) what the different branches are, 2) the powers that the different branches have, and 3) if your constitution had a preamble, what problems or goals the preamble tried to address. OR Describe the differences between the federal government, your state government, and your local government.

Ethics: Part 2

- Ourselves: Book I: Name some enemies of goodwill and show how they behave.

Term 2

Current Events: Grades 5-8

- Tell the story of one of the news events of this term.

Plutarch: Grades 6-8

- Tell me everything you remember about the lives of Agis and Cleomenes. OR You have watched Agesilaus, Agis's own uncle, embrace the reform publicly, help burn the debt bonds in the marketplace, laugh at the "brightest fire" he had ever seen, and then delay the land division once, and again, and again, until the moment was lost and Leonidas came back, and Agis was killed in prison. Agesilaus was not a tyrant. He was not an enemy of Sparta. He was a debtor who did not want to pay. What do you think about his behavior?

American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8

- Reading PDF: Tell about the expansion of the United States into the southeast and the relocation of Tribal Nations. What actions did Congress, the President, and/or the Supreme Court take with regard to Removal? How did tribes respond to Removal efforts?
OR
Tell about the Southern secession and the actions that Congress took in response to the outbreak of the Civil War and as part of Reconstruction following the Civil War. Bonus: How many branches of government became involved in the reconstruction work, and what role did those branches play?

Ethics: Part 2

- Ourselves: Book I: Name some false ideas that hold back generosity OR Show how egotism destroys sympathy.

Term 3

Current Events: Grades 5-8

- Tell the story of one of the news events of this term.

Plutarch: Grades 6-8

- Tell me everything you remember about the lives of the Gracchi. OR
You have followed the Gracchi from Cornelia's house through every assembly, every law, every riot, and into the silence after. You watched Tiberius weep before his father's statue on the last morning of his life, and keep walking. You watched Gaius pull his hand quietly from his wife's grip at the door and not look back. You watched Cornelia lose both sons and go on hosting dinner parties for learned men without shedding a tear. What do you think about their behavior? Is there a right way to face grief, loss, and fear?

American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8

- Dollars & Sense: Tell what you know about the formation of the national banking system OR Tell what you know about the services banks offer.

Ethics: Part 2

- Ourselves: Book I: Show what loyalty to our country means.